ASCII MASTER FLOWCHART

The British Conquest of Bengal

12-panel revision companion | GS-I Modern Indian History

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 1/12: Bengal before 1756: successor state and sovereignty conflict

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BENGAL -> wealthy Mughal successor state, not a political vacuum
1717 FARMAN -> bounded privilege for Company trade | DASTAK ABUSE -> servants' private trade
FORTIFICATION + customs + jurisdiction -> commercial dispute becomes sovereignty dispute
SIRAJ 1756 -> inherits court rivalry and a Company testing Nawabi authority.
MUST REMEMBER: Plassey on 23 June 1757, Buxar on 22 October 1764, the 1765 Allahabad
  settlement and Diwani grant, and the 1765-72 Dual Government are separate stages.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 2/12: Calcutta crisis and the Black Hole caution

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UNAUTHORISED FORTIFICATION -> Kasimbazar seized -> Fort William falls in June 1756
CLIVE / WATSON -> Calcutta recovered -> Alinagar -> Chandernagore removed as counterweight
BLACK HOLE -> Holwell is an interested, weakly corroborated narrator
RULE -> never make a disputed body count or atrocity story the causal centre of conquest.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 3/12: Plassey's hidden battle: conspiracy and collaboration

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COMPANY / CLIVE -> regime-change plan + secret correspondence + coercive leverage
MIR JAFAR -> throne | JAGAT SETH -> credit and security | RAI DURLABH -> office
AMICHAND -> broker later deceived | MIR MADAN / MOHAN LAL -> loyal resistance
VERDICT -> interests explain collaboration better than a one-word betrayal morality tale.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 4/12: Plassey and the Mir Jafar client regime

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PLASSEY, 23 JUNE 1757 -> conspiracy neutralises most Nawabi command
RESULT -> Mir Jafar installed; Company becomes kingmaker and gains political entry
CLIENT CYCLE -> dependence -> transfers / concessions -> deeper Company leverage
LIMIT -> Plassey changed the ruler; it did not yet grant legal-fiscal sovereignty.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 5/12: Mir Qasim: reform, equality and conflict

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MIR QASIM 1760 -> shifts capital to Munger + strengthens administration and army
COMPANY PRIVATE TRADE -> duty privilege distorts competition and weakens Nawabi revenue
RESPONSE 1763 -> abolish inland duties for all traders: equality, not modern nationalism
COMPANY RESISTS LOST ADVANTAGE -> war -> Mir Qasim seeks an Awadh-Mughal coalition.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 6/12: Buxar: coalition breadth versus unified Company command

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COALITION -> Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daula + Shah Alam II; distinct motives
STRUCTURAL WEAKNESS -> separate treasuries, commands and political objectives
COMPANY -> Hector Munro's integrated command, supply and payment system
BUXAR, 22 OCTOBER 1764 -> open military supremacy, unlike Plassey's palace coup.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 7/12: Three-stage conquest thesis

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PLASSEY 1757 -> POLITICAL ENTRY: client Nawab and Company kingmaking
BUXAR 1764 -> MILITARY SUPREMACY: Bengal-Awadh-emperor coalition defeated
ALLAHABAD / DIWANI 1765 -> LEGAL-FISCAL TITLE: revenue authority institutionalised
RULE -> Plassey alone did not complete Company sovereignty over Bengal.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 8/12: Allahabad, Diwani, Nizamat and the Awadh buffer

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12 AUG 1765, SHAH ALAM II -> Company receives Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa
16 AUG 1765, SHUJA-UD-DAULA -> Awadh restored as a strategic buffer, not annexed
DIWANI -> revenue / civil side | NIZAMAT -> nominal police, criminal and military side
CAUTION -> Diwani was not Nawabship and the legal split was not equal power-sharing.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 9/12: Dual Government: power separated from responsibility

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1765-72 -> Company holds revenue power through Indian deputies
NAWAB'S ESTABLISHMENT -> nominal Nizamat and public responsibility without resources
PARADOX -> Company power without responsibility / Nawab responsibility without power
RESULT -> extraction incentives + diffused accountability + weak corrective capacity.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 10/12: Famine, accountability and the 1772 termination

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1770 FAMINE -> harvest failure / drought and disease create the natural shock
DUAL GOVERNMENT -> revenue rigidity and administrative confusion amplify vulnerability
CAUTION -> Company policy mattered but did not alone cause drought or the catastrophe
HASTINGS 1772 -> ends Dual Government; direct administration precedes later constitutional regulation.
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Plassey enabled political leverage through conspiracy and finance; Buxar
  established a broader military-fiscal superiority against Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula and Shah
  Alam II.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 11/12: Company-state, early drain mechanism and historiography

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TRADE PRIVILEGE -> kingmaking -> Diwani -> revenue funds purchases and armies
INDIAN AGENCY -> collaboration, resistance and administration operate under unequal power
LENSES -> nationalist extraction | collaboration | corporate-fiscal state | Bengal continuity
MEMORY ANCHOR -> read Plassey through finance, faction and force, not betrayal alone.
EVIDENCE LIMIT: Company records and later nationalist accounts must be checked against Bengal
  court, banking and revenue evidence; conquest was contingent, collaborative and coercive.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 12/12: Answer spine and chapter boundaries

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OPEN -> sovereignty conflict over privilege, private trade, fortification and jurisdiction
TRACE -> conspiracy / client regime -> reform and war -> Buxar -> Diwani -> Dual Government
WEIGH -> collaboration + Company capacity; famine is multicausal; reject false precision
CLOSE -> 1772 ends this chapter; wider expansion and 1773+ regulation follow.
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